

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Peer Observation Policy

How teachers at Monglish observe one another, give and receive feedback, and document the process.

Non-evaluative

growth and improvement

PO at Monglish Academy is a supportive, non-evaluative process focused on growth and improvement. Every teacher takes part, as an Observer and as a Receiver.

Definitions & Acronyms

Term	Meaning
SLT (Senior Leadership Team)	Principals, Academic Manager and Academic Director
LT (Leadership Team)	Comprises Coordinators, Principals, Academic Manager and Academic Director
Peer Observation (PO)	A PD process in which educators on a similar professional level collaborate to observe and provide feedback on each other's teaching practices.
Observer	In the context of a teacher's peer observation process, an "observer" typically refers to a colleague or fellow educator who is tasked with observing another teacher during a lesson or teaching activity.
Receiver	In the context of a teacher's peer observation process, the "Receiver" typically refers to the teacher who is being observed by their colleague or peer.

Monglish Vision & Mission

V Vision

At Monglish we have a vision to become the best digital academy that provides an unparalleled experience in learning foreign languages, in order to create a positive impact on the lives of our clients.

M Mission

Our mission is to expand globally by offering quality online training, based on the Mongi-Immerse methodology, through our multi-national team of qualified experts.

Our Goals

- The goals we have set ourselves are important steps to assist us in realizing our vision. They empower us to make sure that our work is effective and fruitful for all parties.
- At Monglish International Academy, we aim to achieve excellence and enhance performance at teaching various levels of learners, by offering professional and diverse programs that suit the desire of each learner. We also strive to save learners time and money, by focusing on the goals they wish to achieve, and by setting them up with a flexible schedule to enjoy their online courses, through interactive and live sessions.
- We strive to support our learners by presenting them with interesting content that propels them in the direction of their ambitions to succeed professionally.
- We aspire to provide creative and high-quality courses that surpass the expectations of learners of all levels and backgrounds.

SECTION 1

1 Ethos & Rationale

Why Monglish teachers observe one another.

1.1 Fostering a positive and collaborative culture

Engaging in POs builds trust and mutual respect among teachers and fosters open communication. A school culture that encourages POs is likely to be positive, supportive, and focused on continuous improvement.

1.2 Sharing Learning and Expertise

POs create opportunities for collaboration and learning, fostering the exchange of ideas and effective practices among colleagues. Through these observations, we gain insights into diverse teaching styles and strategies.

1.3 Reflective Practice

POs encourage self-reflection and critical analysis of teaching practices. Feedback received from peers deepens our understanding of strengths and areas for improvement, leading to refined instructional approaches.

1.4 Constructive Feedback

Participating in POs provides us with constructive, supportive feedback based on firsthand observations. This valuable input allows for fresh perspectives, identification of blind spots, and refinement of teaching techniques.

1.5 Increased Self-Awareness

Engaging in POs enhances our self-awareness as educators. We become more mindful of instructional choices, classroom management strategies, and overall teaching presence, fostering intentional and effective teaching practices.

1.6 Professional Growth and Support

POs significantly contribute to ongoing professional growth, fostering a culture of support and continuous improvement within our teaching community. This approach encourages sustained motivation, engagement, and dedication to our careers.

1.7 Promotion of Innovation

POs provide a platform for teachers to share innovative teaching methods and experiment with new approaches. This fosters a culture of continuous improvement and adaptability to evolving educational practices.

1.8 Modeling Best Practices

Through POs, teachers have the opportunity to witness and model best practices firsthand. This exposure encourages the adoption of effective strategies and techniques, elevating the overall standard of teaching within the institution.

1.9 Adaptation to Diverse Learning Styles

Through POs, teachers gain exposure to diverse teaching styles and strategies. This exposure enables them to adapt their instructional approaches to accommodate diverse learning styles among students, ultimately enhancing inclusivity and effectiveness in the classroom.

1.10 Opportunity for Targeted Mentorship

POs provide a structured process for targeted mentorship opportunities. Experienced educators can offer guidance and support to their peers based on shared observations, creating a reciprocal mentorship dynamic that enhances professional growth.

SECTION 2

2 Scope

Area	What the policy says
2.1 Participants	All teachers are to participate in the PO process.
2.2 Frequency	POs will occur regularly under the guidance of the LT.
2.3 Focus Areas	Observations may be overall or focus on various aspects of teaching and learning, including instructional strategies, classroom management techniques, student engagement, assessment practices, differentiation, etc. Observers and Receivers may choose specific focus areas based on specific needs, whether at an individual or organizational level.
2.4 Confidentiality	All observations and feedback discussions are confidential and intended for professional development purposes only. Participants are expected to respect the privacy of their colleagues and maintain confidentiality regarding observation feedback.
2.5 Documentation	Participants are to document POs through filling-in observation forms and post-observation feedback session recordings. Documentation should be kept confidential and shared only with the Observer, Receiver and LT.
2.6 Guidance and Support	Guidance sessions and resources will be provided to support participants in conducting effective POs. Participants will receive guidance on observation techniques, providing constructive feedback, and collaborative reflection.
2.7 Evaluation and Continuous Improvement	The effectiveness of the PO process will be evaluated through feedback surveys, focus groups, or other means of assessment. Feedback will be used to make improvements to the PO policy and process over time.

In short. Every teacher takes part; the LT sets how often; the focus can be the whole lesson or one aspect; everything stays confidential between the Observer, the Receiver and the LT.

SECTION 3

3 Guiding Principles

Criteria for giving and receiving feedback in POs.

PO at Monglish Academy is a supportive, non-evaluative process focused on growth and improvement. Therefore, the following guiding principles are intended to promote trust, confidentiality, respect, and collaboration among colleagues.

3.1 · For Observers

Nine principles: supportive, objective, specific, evidence-based, timely (within 72 hrs), balanced, two-way, reflective and improving.

3.2 · For Receivers

Eight principles: open-minded, not defensive, listening, seeking feedback, seeking clarification, reflecting, acting, and a continuous improvement mindset.

SECTION 3 · CONTINUED

3 Guiding Principles, in full

3.1 Guiding Principles for Observers

- 3.1.i Supportive environment.** Demonstrate effective communication skills when delivering feedback, fostering a positive and growth-oriented atmosphere where teachers feel comfortable discussing feedback.
- 3.1.ii Objectiveness.** Ensure that feedback is grounded in objective information showing no personal bias.
- 3.1.iii Constructive and Specific Feedback.** Provide feedback that is specific, actionable, and tied to observable behaviors. Offer constructive suggestions for improvement while recognizing and reinforcing effective teaching practices.
- 3.1.iv Use of Evidence.** Support feedback with evidence from observations, student performance, or other relevant sources.
- 3.1.v Timeliness.** Give feedback in a timely manner, allowing teachers to make adjustments promptly (within max 72 hrs. of observation).
- 3.1.vi Balanced Feedback.** Maintain a balance between acknowledging strengths and addressing areas for improvement.
- 3.1.vii Two-Way Communication.** Foster an open and two-way communication process, allowing teachers to share their perspectives and concerns.
- 3.1.viii Encourages Reflective Practice.** Promote a culture of reflective practice, encouraging teachers to self-assess and reflect on their teaching methods. Provide guidance on how teachers can engage in self-reflection.
- 3.1.ix Continuous Improvement.** Model a commitment to continuous improvement in the feedback process. Seek feedback from teachers on the effectiveness of the feedback they receive.

3.2 Guiding Principles for Receivers

- 3.2.i Be open-minded.** Approach feedback with an open mind and a willingness to learn and grow. Recognize that feedback is an opportunity for improvement and professional development.
- 3.2.ii Avoidance of Defensiveness.** Steering clear of defensiveness is crucial when receiving feedback. A good feedback receiver does not react defensively but rather views feedback as an opportunity for improvement.
- 3.2.iii Listen actively.** Pay close attention to the feedback you receive and actively listen to understand the observer's perspective. Take notes if necessary to ensure you capture all the important points.
- 3.2.iv Seeking Feedback Proactively.** Proactively seeking feedback is a proactive criterion. A good feedback receiver takes the initiative to request feedback from peers, demonstrating a genuine interest in continuous improvement.
- 3.2.v Seek clarification.** If you are unsure about any aspect of the feedback, don't hesitate to ask for clarification. Seek additional examples or further explanations to fully comprehend the observer's observations and suggestions.
- 3.2.vi Reflect on the feedback.** Take time to reflect on the feedback received. Consider how it aligns with your teaching goals & objectives. Identify areas where you can make adjustments or implement new strategies.
- 3.2.vii Take action.** Use the feedback as a catalyst for improvement. Develop an action plan based on the feedback received and implement the suggested strategies in your teaching practice. Monitor your progress and evaluate the effectiveness of the changes made.
- 3.2.viii Continuous Improvement Mindset.** Embracing a mindset of continuous improvement is fundamental. A strong feedback receiver views feedback as a part of an ongoing journey of professional development, demonstrating a commitment to lifelong learning.

SECTION 4

4 Implementation

4.1 Peer Selection

- **4.1.i** Teachers will be paired for PO sessions at the discretion of the LT.
- **4.1.ii** Pairings are determined either randomly or based on various criteria deemed relevant to the objectives of the observation process. These criteria may include, but are not limited to, teaching experience, area expertise, instructional methodologies, & PD goals (whether at the individual or organizational level).
- **4.1.iii** The LT will ensure that pairings are balanced and conducive to meaningful peer learning experiences.
- **4.1.iv** These pairings will be documented in a tracker to facilitate varied pairings in subsequent PORs to ensure a diverse range of perspectives and learning opportunities (refer to PO Pairing Tracker).

4.2 Scheduling

Throughout the cycle, POs will be conducted via two distinct approaches:

i PO Rounds (PORs)

In PO Rounds, the whole team of teachers are paired with colleagues for observation sessions at scheduled intervals throughout the cycle. The pairing process is organized and managed by the LT, ensuring that each teacher has the opportunity to both observe and be observed by different colleagues throughout the cycle.

- **Rounds and pairings:** there will be 1 POR per cycle and 1 pairing, i.e. in each round, each teacher will have the opportunity to have 1 turn as an observer and 1 turn as a receiver within their designated pairing.
- **Creation of round schedule:** the LT will create an observation schedule outlining the dates, times, and pairings for each observation session. Factors such as teacher availability, class schedules, and other aspects are taken into account during scheduling.
- **Communication and Preparation:** teachers will be informed about the upcoming POR schedule at least a week beforehand and reminded of the guiding principles (refer to PO Guiding Principles form).

ii Sporadic POs

In this approach, PO sessions occur intermittently throughout the cycle, at the discretion of the LT.

4.3 Procedures at a glance

01 - optional

Pre-observation meeting

Build rapport

02

Observation session

Notes and PO Form

03 - within 72 hrs

Feedback meeting

Recorded, form on screen

04

Reflection forms

Observer and Receiver

05

Documentation

Send to the designated email

06

Tracking

Coordinators record it

SECTION 4 · CONTINUED

4.3 Procedures

Step	What happens
4.3.i Pre-Observation Meeting (optional)	The Observer and Receiver may choose to meet before the designated observation session in order to establish rapport and facilitate a comfortable environment.
4.3.ii Observation Session	- The Observer attends the observation session taking detailed notes, mentioning examples. - The Observer fills in the PO Form.
4.3.iii Post-Observation Feedback Meeting	Abiding by the PO Guiding Principles: - Following the observation, the Observer and Receiver meet to discuss the observation findings. - This meeting must be recorded. - The Observer must share, on the screen, the PO Form for the Receiver to see. - The Observer provides constructive feedback, highlighting strengths and areas for improvement. - The Receiver may ask questions or seek clarification on the feedback provided. - The 2 members discuss the process and thank each other/end the meeting with a cordial comment.
4.3.iv Reflection Forms	Both the Observer and Receiver fill in Reflection Forms to document their experience.
4.3.v Documentation	- The Observer sends the PO Form to the designated email address CCing the Receiver. - The Observer and Receiver send their Reflection Forms to the designated email address.
4.3.vi Professional Development Opportunities	These documents may highlight professional development opportunities that may arise such as workshops, seminars, and reflective practices, to support teachers in addressing identified areas for improvement.
4.3.vii Evaluation and Continuous Improvement	- The LT will evaluate the effectiveness of the PO process on an ongoing basis and make adjustments as needed to improve outcomes. - Feedback from participants may be solicited to inform future revisions to the policy and procedures.

The feedback meeting, in three rules. It is recorded. The PO Form is on the screen for the Receiver to see. It ends with thanks or a cordial comment.

SECTION 4 · CONTINUED

4.4 Dispute resolution

i Communication

- Should a dispute arise, members are to reach out to their direct line-managers.
- All parties involved in the dispute are expected to communicate openly and respectfully about their concerns.

ii Mediation

- A member of the LT will act as a mediator.
- The mediator will investigate before scheduling a meeting with the relevant members, e.g. hear the perspectives of each member, watch recordings, read the documents.
- A meeting will be scheduled to facilitate discussions between the parties involved.

The mediation meeting will take place as follows. Throughout the mediation process, the mediator should remain neutral and impartial, facilitating constructive communication.

Stage	What happens
a. Introduction	The mediator will outline the purpose of the meeting and establish ground rules for the discussion, e.g. respectful communication, active listening, taking turns to speak, no interruptions, allowing the other member to finish.
b. Joint discussion	The mediator will facilitate a joint discussion where all parties have the opportunity to share their viewpoints, concerns and proposed solutions.
c. Negotiation and agreement	After hearing all the viewpoints, the parties engage in a negotiation to identify common ground and explore potential compromises or solutions.
d. Closure	Once an agreement is reached, the mediator reiterates the terms of the agreement and the next steps to ensure mutual understanding and acceptance.
e. Follow-up	• After the mediation session, the mediator will email the minutes of meeting including the agreements to the relevant parties (CCing the SLT). • A copy will also be documented in the portfolio of each member. • The mediator may also follow up with the participants to assess their abiding by the agreements and/or satisfaction with the resolution process and outcomes.

4.5 Tracking of performance

- Upon receipt of all documents from both peers, the coordinators shall proceed to extract the information and record it in the relevant tracker.
- Appropriate action plans shall then be devised and implemented accordingly.

i Comments on the process itself

All comments regarding the process itself will be extracted and recorded in the PO Process Feedback Tracker.

ii Reflections on Observers and Receivers

All reflections (comments & scores) regarding each of the Observer and the Receiver will be extracted and recorded in their personal tabs in the PO Performance Tracker. Scores will also be added to the Overall Professional Competency Tracker (refer to Succession Planning Policy).

SECTIONS 5 AND 6

5 Related Documents

1 PO Rubric & Feedback Form

2 Teachers' Portfolios

3 Teacher's Summative
Appraisal Form

4 PO Guiding Principles Form

5 PO Pairings Tracker

6 PO Observer Reflection Form

7 PO Receiver Reflection Form

8 PO Process Feedback Tracker

9 PO Performance Tracker

10 Overall Professional
Competency Tracker

11 Academic Leadership
Succession Planning Policy

6 Monitoring the Effectiveness of this Policy

This policy will be reviewed periodically by the CEO & Academic SLT. The next review will be in June 2024.

Once again, PO in our academy is a process focused on growth and improvement. It is not meant to be evaluative, but only intended to hone your skills both as an observer and receiver and to provide valuable opportunities for self-reflection.